

Verified

UEFA European Championship

The European Championship began in 1960 as the European Nations' Cup. Early final tournaments had only four teams. The modern EURO expanded to eight teams in 1980, sixteen in 1996, and twenty-four in 2016.

UEFA European Championship editions, 1960 onward

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final
2024	Germany	24	Spain	England	France	Netherlands	Spain 2-1 England
2020	Eleven European cities	24	Italy	England	Spain	Denmark	1-1; Italy pens

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final
2016	France	24	<u>Portugal</u>	France	Germany	Wales	Portugal 1 France (a.)
2012	Poland and Ukraine	16	<u>Spain</u>	Italy	Germany	Portugal	Spain 4-0
2008	Austria and Switzerland	16	<u>Spain</u>	Germany	Russia	Türkiye	Spain 1-0 Germany
2004	Portugal	16	<u>Greece</u>	Portugal	Czech Republic	Netherlands	Greece 1- Portugal

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final
2000	Belgium and Netherlands	16	<u>France</u>	Italy	Portugal	Netherlands	France 2–1 Italy (gold goal)
1996	England	16	<u>Germany</u>	Czech Republic	England	France	Germany 2–1 Czech Rep (golden goal)
1992	Sweden	8	<u>Denmark</u>	Germany	Netherlands	Sweden	Denmark 1–0 Germany
1988	West Germany	8	<u>Netherlands</u>	Soviet Union	West Germany	Italy	Netherlands 1–0 Soviet Union
1984	France	8	<u>France</u>	Spain	Portugal	Denmark	France 2–0 Spain

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final
1980	Italy	8	<u>West Germany</u>	Belgium	Czechoslovakia	Italy	West Gern 2-1 Belgiu
1976	Yugoslavia	4	<u>Czechoslovakia</u>	West Germany	Netherlands	Yugoslavia	2-2; Czechoslo 5-3 pens
1972	Belgium	4	<u>West Germany</u>	Soviet Union	Belgium	Hungary	West Gern 3-0 Soviet Union
1968	Italy	4	<u>Italy</u>	Yugoslavia	England	Soviet Union	Italy 2-0 Yugoslavia (replay)
1964	Spain	4	<u>Spain</u>	Soviet Union	Hungary	Denmark	Spain 2-1 Soviet Uni

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Other semifinalist	Other semifinalist / fourth	Final
1960	France	4	Soviet Union	Yugoslavia	Czechoslovakia	France	Soviet Uni 2–1 Yugos (a.e.t.)

Champions by titles

Generated automatically from the edition table above. Totals group a nation with its sporting predecessor only where the source content does (Germany includes West Germany); every other name is counted as written.

Spain 1964, 2008, 2012, 2024	4
Germany (incl. West Germany) 1972, 1980, 1996	3
Italy 1968, 2020	2

France

2

1984, 2000

Soviet Union

1

1960

Czechoslovakia

1

1976

Netherlands

1

1988

Denmark

1

1992

Greece

1

2004

Portugal

1

2016

How it works

- UEFA national teams qualify over roughly two years of group matches before the finals.
- The finals open with a group stage; the best-placed teams in each group move on.
- From the quarterfinals onward it is a straight knockout: a single loss ends a team's tournament.
- The final decides the champion; no third-place match has been played since 1980 (see "Historical format note" below).

Historical format note

A third-place match was played through 1980. From 1984 onward, UEFA recognizes both defeated semifinalists without ranking them third and fourth. The table therefore uses neutral “other semifinalist” wording.

Memorable moments

- Antonín Panenka's famous chipped penalty decided the 1976 shoot-out.
- Denmark entered the 1992 tournament late and went on to win it.
- Greece produced one of international football's greatest surprises in 2004.
- Spain became the first nation to retain the EURO title in 2012.
- The delayed EURO 2020 was played in 2021 across multiple countries.
- Spain won a record fourth title in 2024.

References & review

Status: verified

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Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.